4 Matching URLs to Razor Pages with routing

This chapter covers

- Evaluating how URLs are matched to Razor pages
- Examining the use of route templates to control the matching process
- Working with data passed in URLs
- Overriding conventional routes
- Generating outbound URLs

In the last chapter, we looked at how to influence which handler method is invoked for a particular request by incorporating an HTTP method name into the name of a handler method—for example, `OnGet`, `OnPost`, and so on. Before the handler selection process can take place, the correct page must be selected. This chapter focuses on *routing*, which is the process that maps the incoming request to a specific page, or *endpoint* (incoming URLs), and generates URLs that map to those endpoints (outgoing URLs).

Many web application frameworks map URLs to a web page's file path on disk based on matching the URL segments to a folder structure. Continuing the theme of a web application that provides vacation packages from the last chapter, table 4.1 provides some examples of this one-to-one match between some imagined segmented URLs and their file paths in a web application.

Table 4.1 It is common to find a one-to-one mapping between incoming URLs and page file paths.